VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF FRI OCT 23 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

A $40 billion lease for GPUs

SpaceX has signed a binding commitment letter for a master finance lease of about $40 billion with an entity managed by Apollo, under which the lessor buys pods of graphics processing units (GPUs) and leases them to SpaceX, according to an 8-K accepted by the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) at 8:00 a.m. EDT Monday. The letter was signed on Saturday, October 24. Each lease schedule runs about five to five and a quarter years, with rent paid quarterly in advance: one-twentieth of the financed cost plus a fixed annual rate and costs. Closing is expected before the end of the year, and schedules begin in the first half of 2027 as the hardware is delivered.

Elon Musk had previewed the deal on Sunday. "SpaceX closed $40B of debt for GPUs, but we're investment grade and have Starlink & launch revenue," he posted at 3:11 p.m. EDT, and half an hour later added that it is "primarily callable debt for GPU purchases that will arrive in Q1 and Q2. Not a major factor this quarter." CNBC reported the filing Monday morning. SPCX rose 1.89% on Friday to $147.49.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

Starlink 15-15 flies on the fourth try

Falcon 9 lifted off from Vandenberg Friday evening after three scrubs, and Super Heavy Booster 22 fired all 33 engines on Sunday.



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg Space Force Base with NASA's SWOT satellite on Dec. 16, 2022. Starlink 15-15 flew from the same pad on Friday.
PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Falcon 9 lifted off from Vandenberg Space Force Base at 6:48 p.m. EDT Friday with Starlink 15-15, "After three previous scrubs," Spaceflight Now posted. The booster, B1063, was making its 36th flight (NASASpaceflight). At 7:51 p.m. EDT SpaceX posted: "Deployment of 27 @Starlink satellites confirmed."

Booster 22's static fire

At Starbase, Texas, Booster 22 was lifted onto the launch mount at Pad 2 on Saturday (NASASpaceflight) and fired its engines at 9:22 a.m. EDT Sunday, Spaceflight News reported. "Full duration 33-engine static fire for the Super Heavy booster preparing for Flight 15," SpaceX posted at 3:49 p.m. EDT. The booster was lifted back off the pad after midnight, while Ship 43, assigned to Flight 16, returned from the Massey's test site and Ship 42, for Flight 15, took its place, NASASpaceflight posted.

QUICK HIT

Florida debut. Flight 16 is "set to be Starship's Florida debut," NASASpaceflight posted Sunday, with fresh flyover photos of the launch facilities.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

Two Vandenberg Starlinks slip a day

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next five weeks, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern: EDT through November 1, EST after.

DATE / TIME (EDT/EST)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Tue Oct 27, 12:45 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1082, 26th flight, landing on Of Course I Still Love You. **Moved** from Sat Oct 24, then Mon Oct 26; no reason given	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2; SpaceX mission page
Fri Oct 30, 12:02 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-18, 27 V2 Mini satellites. **Moved** from Thu Oct 29, 12:17 a.m.; no reason given	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2
Thu Nov 5, 12:14 a.m. EST	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-21	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Thu Nov 5, 5:34 p.m. EST	Falcon 9	NROL-195, National Reconnaissance Office	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
November	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; booster static fire completed Oct 25	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight; Spaceflight News (NET Nov 8, unofficial)
NET Nov 30	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
Later	Starship	Flight 16, Ship 43; first Starship launch from Florida	LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) date or month, or an unofficial target. Changes since Friday's issue: Starlink 15-15 launched Friday; Starlink 15-16, listed for Monday at 1:00 a.m., is now Tuesday at 12:45 a.m. (Spaceflight Now: "Delayed from Oct. 24"); Starlink 15-18 moved from Thursday to Friday, October 30. Neither move came with a stated reason. Starship Flight 15, which Friday's issue listed for mid-November, is described as "November's Flight 15" by NASASpaceflight; aviation data point to NET November 8 (Spaceflight News). Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A). ISS: International Space Station.

Starship: Raptor fix, catches planned



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024. NASA says Flight 15 will likely try to catch both the booster and the ship.
PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

NASA's Artemis program manager, Jeremy Parsons, said at Friday's briefing that SpaceX has found the root cause of the Raptor engine relight failures and that an improved Raptor flies on Flight 15, Spaceflight News reported. Flight 15 is probably in November, both vehicles have been cryo-proofed, and the flight will likely attempt booster and ship catches. A photo from the Starfactory shown at the event "confirms upgraded Raptors for Flight 15," NASASpaceflight posted.

Sunday's test closed the beach and State Highway 4 under a mayor's order, with Monday as a backup day (Spaceflight News). SpaceX has not announced a launch date.

III · STARLINK

easyJet signs on; Ukraine's drones speed up again

A second European airline brand, schools in Bolivia, and a weekend fight over Starlink's terms of service.

Airlines

easyJet will offer onboard connectivity for the first time, with Starlink installed across its A320, A320neo and A321neo fleet from the first half of 2027 and the rollout finished by early 2028, the airline announced Monday. Starlink posted at 8:26 a.m. EDT that passengers will be able to "work, stream, or stay in touch without interruption." Aer Lingus has finished installing free Starlink Wi-Fi on its long-haul fleet of A330s and A321LR/XLRs, covering all of its U.S. routes, One Mile at a Time reported. "A cunning move by Aer Lingus," Musk posted Sunday.

Ukraine

Ukraine's Defense Ministry said Saturday that Starlink and Starshield speeds had been restored and that the connection "remains stable" on equipment moving above 400 kilometers per hour, CNBC reported. Since October 14, Ukrainian officials had accused SpaceX of speed limits on Starshield that cut off drones flying faster than 100 miles per hour. President Donald Trump confirmed a report that he had asked Musk to ease the restrictions: "I have spoken to Elon Musk."

"Ukraine military violated Starlink terms of service and used it for offensive drone strikes to kill people. That loophole was closed last week," Musk wrote (CNBC). "Starshield, a different system, is controlled by the US government. What they decide to do is up to them," he posted, and later: "We simply enforced our terms of service when they were bypassed. There has been no change to our terms of service" (post). Lawmakers from both parties have called for a formal probe of the changes (CNBC).

QUICK HIT

Bolivia's schools. President Rodrigo Paz signed agreements with 85 municipalities to install Starlink antennas in schools, with a national target of about 4,700 antennas, Correo del Sur reported. "Starlink in Bolivia!" Musk posted.

Starlink V3, "which only just started launching, will have ~100 times more bandwidth than the current V2 system," Musk posted Saturday, replying to a post that put Starlink's subscribers at 13.6 million.

IV · THE MOON

Artemis III: Blue Moon first, then Starship

NASA laid out a 14-day Earth-orbit test mission for 2027, with Orion docking to both companies' lander test articles.



From left, NASA Deputy Press Secretary George Alderman, Administrator Jared Isaacman, Associate Administrator Amit Kshatriya and Artemis program manager Jeremy Parsons at the Artemis update at Kennedy Space Center on Oct. 23, 2026.

PHOTO: NASA/CORY S. HUSTON · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Artemis III will send NASA astronauts Randy Bresnik, Frank Rubio and Andre Douglas and the European Space Agency's Luca Parmitano into low Earth orbit in 2027 to practice with test versions of the Blue Origin and SpaceX landers, NASA said Friday. Blue Origin launches a Blue Moon Mark 2 test article first; Orion docks to it for about two days of crewed checks. SpaceX then launches a Starship Version 3 test article from Florida, which will "carry an added docking system mounted at the forward end." Orion docks to it for up to two hours, and "Crew will not enter Starship during this test."

The Starship docking comes on flight day eight, NASASpaceflight posted from the briefing, where NASA also said two Starlink terminals are installed on the Artemis III Orion (post). The first crewed landing is planned for Artemis IV in 2028 (NASA). Asked how many tanker flights a Starship landing needs, Parsons said NASA was not tracking as high as 22 and pointed to SpaceX's estimate of six to eight (Spaceflight News). "Back to the Moon," Musk posted.

V · AI & COMPUTE

"Guppy-level death" for neoclouds

Musk argued that debt markets have closed to most GPU renters, and said SpaceX will not buy them.

"As of the past few weeks, debt markets have almost entirely shut off access to money for any company that doesn't have substantial revenue independent of AI data centers," Musk posted Sunday. "That means the 200+ neoclouds are going to see guppy-level death and consolidation. In a separate post he wrote: "SpaceX is not buying any neoclouds. Pointless."

"I think we're going to see a lot of stranded compute in partially complete data centers," he wrote Saturday night, and on demand: "Agentic demand is growing faster than I've ever seen anything grow" (post). On how to value GPUs, he posted that "Accounting depreciation is irrelevant," adding, "Delivering on projected cash flow is what matters."

VI · FILINGS: SEC, FAA & FCC

An 8-K and an FCC rulemaking

The GPU lease filing Monday morning; the Federal Communications Commission's space-licensing overhaul opened for comment.

SEC

8-K · Oct 26, 8:00 a.m. EDT — Item 8.01: binding commitment letter, dated Oct 24, for a master finance lease of about $40 billion with an Apollo-managed lessor that will buy GPU pods; schedules of about 5 to 5¼ years; closing expected before year end. Signed by Chief Financial Officer Bret Johnsen. Filing

FCC

Oct 26 · Space Modernization — Further notice of proposed rulemaking (SB Docket No. 25-306, FCC 26-47) published in the Federal Register; comments due Nov 25, replies Dec 28. Federal Register

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Nov 4 · Surety bond — Due under the October 6 order granting 15,000 Gen2 direct-to-device satellites in part. Exterra

FAA

Open · Starbase PEIS — Comments on the Federal Aviation Administration's Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement for more Starship-Super Heavy operations at Starbase (docket FAA-2026-12808) are due November 30. No new FAA notices since. Federal Register

BY THE NUMBERS

$40B	GPU finance lease in Monday's 8-K
15,000	Gen2 direct-to-device satellites in the FCC's October 6 partial grant (Exterra)
36th	Flight of booster B1063 on Starlink 15-15 (NASASpaceflight)
33	Engines fired in Booster 22's static fire (Spaceflight News)

COMING UP

Tue., Oct. 27 · 12:45am EDT Starlink 15-16 from Vandenberg (Spaceflight Now)

Thu., Oct. 29 FCC open meeting (Broadband Breakfast)

Wed., Nov. 25 FCC space-modernization comments due (Federal Register)

Takeaways

1. SpaceX disclosed a $40 billion GPU finance lease with an Apollo-managed lessor.
2. Starlink 15-15 launched Friday after three scrubs.
3. Booster 22 completed a full-duration static fire for Flight 15.
4. easyJet will fit its fleet with Starlink from 2027.
5. Artemis III will dock Orion to Blue Moon and Starship test articles.

SOURCES

Posts by @SpaceX, @Starlink, @SpaceflightNow, @NASASpaceflight and @elonmusk on X; Spaceflight Now, Launch Library 2, SpaceX, Spaceflight News, NASA, Federal Register; easyJet, One Mile at a Time, CNBC, Correo del Sur, Broadband Breakfast, Exterra; SEC EDGAR and prospectus; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain); Wikimedia Commons (Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0).

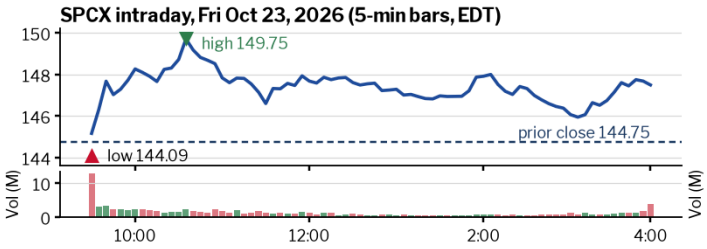
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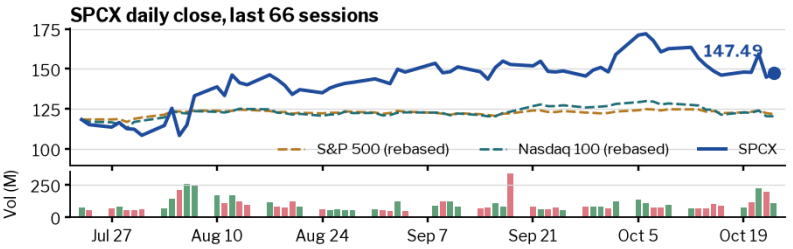
Up 1.9% on Friday as the market slips

SPCX gained as the S&P 500 fell 0.52%; Rocket Lab and AST SpaceMobile each rose more than 2.6%.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$147.49	**+$2.74**	**$147.93**	**$149.75**	**$144.09**
Fri Oct 23, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*+1.89% vs $144.75*	*regular session*	*10:35 a.m. EDT bar*	*9:30 a.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**RANGE SINCE IPO**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**SINCE LISTING**
110.35M	**$105–$226**	**$2.00T**	**+1.0% / −0.4%**	**+9.3%**
+10.4% vs 30-session avg 99.97M	*no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)*	*13.58B Class A+B shares (Oct 15) × close*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs $135 IPO price; −8.36% vs first close*

SINCE IPO — low $104.83 · Aug 3 | close $147.49 | high $225.64 · Jun 16; 50-day avg $149.24





As of close Oct 23, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 23 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**+1.89%**	**+1.00%**	**−0.36%**	**−8.36%**
S&P 500	−0.52%	−0.47%	−1.04%	+2.59%
Nasdaq 100	0.00%	−0.79%	−4.99%	−2.29%
RKLB	+2.69%	+3.46%	−28.54%	−48.63%
ASTS	+2.63%	−2.14%	−34.83%	−51.72%
IRDM	+1.39%	+1.46%	−9.18%	−6.17%

OPTIONS (CBOE, FRI OCT 23 CLOSE)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 26	53,864	61,360	1.14	41.0%	$155 / $140
Oct 28	27,279	24,203	0.89	50.2%	$155 / $160
Oct 30	190,343	174,723	0.92	53.1%	$190 / $150
Nov 6	57,275	59,606	1.04	53.6%	$200 / $135
All expiries	**2,307,485**	**2,373,245**	**1.03**		**30-day IV index 51.7**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 26

Strong buy	8
Buy	23
Hold	5
Sell	2
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.68
Mean target (35 analysts)	$257.91 (+74.9%)
Median target	$245.00
High / low target	$800.00 / $70.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.65%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.49%
Held by institutions	47.65%
Alphabet, Jun 30	6.68%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.10%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 23 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS $0.23)	641
Forward P/E (est. $2.50)	59.0
Price/sales (rev. $32.04B)	62.5
Beta	—
50-day average	$149.24 (−1.2%)
200-day average	—
Q4 EPS est. (23 analysts)	$0.40
Q4 revenue est. (24)	$22.70B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 22	Bank of America	Buy	$235 to $275
Oct 22	Pivotal Research	Buy	$230 to $260
Oct 21	JPMorgan	Overweight	$240 to $500
Oct 21	Evercore ISI	Outperform	$275 to $300
Oct 21	Barclays	Overweight	$254 to $300
Oct 21	Wells Fargo	Overweight	$214 to $274
Oct 21	Susquehanna	Neutral	$173 to $176

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Mon Oct 26	**Lock-up tranche of up to 328.4M shares first tradable**
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Fri Oct 30	Weekly options expiry (190,343 calls open)
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Wed Nov 25	FCC space-modernization comments due
Mon Nov 30	FAA Starbase PEIS scoping comments due
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends (remaining 797.6M)
By year end	$40B GPU lease expected to close

Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Oct 26. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; OI, IV at Friday's close; ATM IV at $147. Shares: 10-Q cover. IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4). Lease: 8-K. FCC dates: Federal Register, Exterra, Broadband Breakfast.